

new group when all existing groups are collapsed or when the lowest-level button is active. If two groups overlap, the common cells in both groups are grouped at the next higher level.

The hidden cells, when the nodes are collapsed, are not available for use in any formula, and charts prepared from the visible items will change to reflect the changes in the visibility of the source range.

The Ungroup button in the same block can ungroup a cell range. To remove all groups in the spreadsheet, select one cell and use the Clear Outline option. Auto Outline automates the process of creating levels, and is used with the Subtotal feature to Summarise data, as discussed next.

4.4 Summarising Data

Grouping large blocks of data facilitates the handling of large spreadsheets by reducing the scrolling required. But this in no way offers any information regarding the contents of the spreadsheet. Summarising is an important process used to convey the important points pertaining to a large block of data.

Summarisation usually involves collating the important or interesting bits of information about a large block of data. Information like Total, Maximum, Average, Number of Records etc, are part of any summary report. Excel offers the Subtotal tool to accomplish summarisation of a large block of data. The name is a misnomer, since the same tool can be used to generate other summary information like Average, Maximum, Number of records, etc. As part of the summarisation process, Excel creates Summary Rows to report the statistics of a group of similar entries. An overall summary for all the groups is also added. When combined with Excel's ability to create levels of groups, you can easily manage and summarise large blocks of data.